

Introduction

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1. ABOUT

The [Forest Business Alliance](#) provides technical assistance, delivers workshops, and facilitates a peer-learning network to increase local and regional capacity for applicants to CAL FIRE's Business and Workforce Development Program.

2. FUNDING

Funding for the Forest Business Alliance is provided by the [CAL FIRE Business and Workforce Development Grant Program](#). Past funders include the [Yuba Water Agency](#) and USDA Forest Service.



3. AUDIENCE

Businesses, Tribal organizations, nonprofits, and other entities are creating sustainable wood product facilities and businesses. The guide provides key insights and advice on accessing funds. More information and templates for the CAL FIRE Business and Workforce Development and USDA Forest Service Wood Innovation Grants can be found at the [Forest Business Alliance](#) website. Feedback is welcome. Contact us directly at forestbusinessalliance@gmail.com.

4. CONTENTS

We will add new chapters as they become ready. Please check back regularly!

1. **Introduction.** This chapter.

2. **Program Design.** How to create a program or strategy for your organization/business.
3. **Proposals.** A startup guide for project design and writing proposals.
4. **Monitoring.** Monitoring and evaluation of your program and projects. Testing assumptions inherent in your theory of change.
5. **eCivis.** Managing your application and project using eCivis.
6. **Compliance Pathways.** Overview of the California Environmental Quality Act and its application to forest-based business/organization projects.
7. **Resilience Gap.** An analysis by New Leaf Climate Partners examining fuel reduction needs to decrease risks of severe wildfire for private forest owners in low-income communities in California.
8. **Funding Analysis.** Examines funding distribution for the CAL FIRE Business and Workforce Development Grants Program.
9. **Scaling.** Scaling forest business and organizational reach and impact.
10. **Grant Management.** Now that you have a grant, how do you successfully manage it?
11. **Startup pathways.** Coming Soon. Lessons and approaches for new businesses negotiating the challenges posed by startup.
12. **Cases.** Case studies of successful business and workforce development in California's forest health sector. The first case featured the Washoe Tribe's Elder, Share & Sale Firewood Program followed by Plumas Wood Fiber and Forestry Collective. More to come soon.
13. **Grant Closeout.** How to leverage and learn from closing out your grant.
14. **FBA Review.** Review of FBA Phase I with recommendations for future work.